Techfest 2026-27

2nd APCTT Hackathon 2026

AI for Technology Readiness

Objective:

To develop functional AI-powered, AI-assisted, or hybrid assessment tools capable of evaluating Technology Readiness Levels (TRL 1–9) from unstructured technical documentation, streamlining technology transfer workflows, and providing transparent, auditable evidence for innovation ecosystems across developing nations.

Challenge Question:

How can an AI pipeline accurately parse raw technology documentation (e.g., patents, research papers, R&D reports), predict its correct Technology Readiness Level (TRL 1–9), synthesize supporting evidence, and output an auditable, actionable gap analysis to guide technology progression?

Note on Evaluation & Instructions: The detailed problem statement instructions, specific dataset guidelines, assessment criteria checklist, and development sample cases will be officially released to all registered teams on **October 10, 2026**, immediately after registrations close.

Scope & Required Deliverables

The complete dataset guidelines, assessment criteria, sample development cases, and detailed track specifications will be officially released to all registered teams on **October 10, 2026**.

Format of Competition:

Round 1: AI Hackathon & Hidden Evaluation (Online):

Structure: Teams develop their AI model using approved public data sources. Upon submission, models undergo a strict code/model freeze. Organizers execute frozen models on an undisclosed private evaluation set.

Registered teams are allowed a maximum of **3 code submission attempts** before the Stage 1 deadline.

For the **first 2 submissions**, organizers will run automated testing on the code and provide diagnostic feedback, including operational execution status (whether the code runs successfully or fails) and benchmark performance scores.

The **3rd submission** serves as the final, immutable entry for official Stage 1 ranking and code freeze

Evaluation Criteria (100% Performance-Based):

- Model Ordinal Accuracy & Precision on Hidden Evaluation Set (Primary Score)
- Strict pass/fail compliance on output schema, execution speed, and dependency checks

Round 2: System Hackathon & Grand Finale (IIT Bombay Campus)

Structure: National finalists integrate their Stage 1 frozen model into a working end-to-end system. On Day 2, teams process undisclosed live-challenge technology files, demonstrate system usability, and pitch to an expert panel.

Team Specification and Eligibility

- **Age Limit:** All participants must be **35 years of age or younger** on December 17, 2026.
- **Team Size:** Teams of **1 to 3 members**.
- **Eligibility:** Open to undergraduate/postgraduate students, researchers, independent developers, and industry professionals.
- **Single Registration Rule:** A participant can only be part of one team. Duplicate registrations lead to immediate disqualification.

Timeline:

Event:	**Date:**
Online Registration Opens	September 17, 2026
Registration Closes	October 10, 2026

Model Training Guide & Criteria Released	October 10, 2026
Final Model & Code Submission Deadline (Stage 1)	November 15, 2026 (23:59 IST)
Announcement of National Finalists	December 1, 2026
Pre-Event Technical Check & Integration Rehearsal	December 2–11, 2026
Stage 2 System Hackathon Grand Finale (IIT Bombay)	December 16–17, 2026

General Rules of the Competition

1. All teams from India must register on techfest.org to receive an official Team ID, which is mandatory for tracking and all submission pathways.
2. Submissions are frozen at the Stage 1 deadline; no model retraining, fine-tuning, or replacement is permitted for Stage 2.
3. Minor integration-related bug fixes during Stage 2 require explicit written authorization from the Technical Evaluation Lead.
4. Submissions must represent the team's original work. Pre-existing code and model weights remain the property of the participants.
5. Finalists must release their Stage 2 deployment package under the Apache License 2.0 for non-profit developmental use.
6. Use of undisclosed private API keys, hardcoded output schemas, or plagiarism will result in immediate disqualification.
7. The use of unauthorized external AI tools during live rounds is strictly prohibited unless explicitly allowed by the judges.
8. Instructions for specific rounds will be communicated on time to registered email IDs, and official announcements will be posted on techfest.org.
9. All contest queries must be submitted through the official portal's Doubt section.
10. Decisions made by the judges, Techfest Organizers, and the APCTT Evaluation Panel are final and binding on all participants.

Certificate Policy

- **Certificate of Participation:** Issued to all registered teams that successfully submit a valid Stage 1 runnable model passing technical compliance.
- **Certificate of Excellence:** Awarded to all national finalists qualifying for Stage 2 at IIT Bombay.
- **Certificate of Merit:** Awarded to the top 3 podium-winning teams of the Grand Finale.

Prize Money & Rewards:

- **1st Place:** USD $2,000 equivalent + Regional APCTT Flagship Showcase Invitation
- **2nd Place:** USD $1,500 equivalent + Regional APCTT Flagship Showcase Invitation
- **3rd Place:** USD $1,500 equivalent + Regional APCTT Flagship Showcase Invitation

(Note: Travel costs for the representatives of the top three winning teams to present at the APCTT Regional Showcase will be covered by APCTT.)